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Lead Product Manager

Government Digital Service

Apply before 11:55 pm on Thursday 23rd April 2026

Government Digital Service

Reference number

456804

Salary

£67,126 - £83,027

£67,972 - £75,275 (National) / £73,280 - £83,027 (London)-Based on capability. The base salary of this grade is £71,370 for London and £67,126 for other locations. Offers made above this will be made up with a specialist pay allowance.

Job grade

Grade 6

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

GDS - Products & Services

Type of role

Digital
Information Technology

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time, Compressed hours

Number of jobs available

1

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Location

London, Manchester

About the job

Job summary

The Government Digital Service (GDS) is the digital centre of government. We are responsible for setting, leading and delivering the vision for a modern digital government.

Our priorities are to drive a modern digital government, by:

1. joining up public sector services
2. harnessing the power of AI for the public good
3. strengthening and extending our digital and data public infrastructure
4. elevating leadership and investing in talent
5. funding for outcomes and procuring for growth and innovation
6. committing to transparency and driving accountability

We are home to the Incubator for Artificial Intelligence (I.AI), the world-leading GOV.UK and at the forefront of coordinating the UK s geospatial strategy and activity. We lead the Government Digital and Data function and champion the work of digital teams across government.

We re part of the Department for Science, Innovation and Technology (DSIT) and employ more than 1,000 people all over the UK, with hubs in Manchester, London and Bristol.

The Government Digital Service is where talent translates into impact. From your first day, you ll be working with some of the world s most highly-skilled digital professionals, all contributing their knowledge to make change on a national scale.

The Products & Services Directorate (P&S) within GDS is responsible for the GOV.UK app, as well as common capabilities, products and tools for others to use and create great public services that are accessible, inclusive and easy to use:

GOV.UK app: building a personalised and proactive relationship with users, making it easier to interact with government

- GOV.UK AI: maximising opportunities of current technological advances to develop citizen facing AI experiences
- GOV.UK Mailbox, GOV.UK Pay, GOV.UK Notify, GOV.UK Forms and Emergency Alerts: building services once, to be used across government, local authorities and police forces

Join us for rewarding work that makes a difference across the UK. You'll solve some of the nation s highest-priority digital challenges, helping millions of people access services they need

Job description

We are seeking a Lead Product Manager in the GDS Product and Services directorate. These are unique roles in government leading nation scale products that will be used by millions of citizens, across government departments and the wider public sector. This includes products such as GOV.UK Mailbox - our new communication platform for citizens, and GOV.UK app - which will provide a personalised experience for citizens interacting across government.

A lead product manager is responsible for a product portfolio or end-to-end service, and the delivery of product quality and value. They work with teams to identify, implement and improve strategies and tactics for their products. They are a member of the management team for their product area and provide product leadership and direction across multiple teams.

As a Lead Product Manager for GDS, you ll:

- own and be responsible for developing and articulating a clear vision, proposition and roadmap for your product area, aligned to the wider product strategy
- lead multidisciplinary product teams day to day in running, supporting and continuously improving products so that they meet user needs
- manage the prioritisation for your product, balancing live service needs with continual improvement
- lead teams in assessing new information about the needs of potential users of the platform, and making decisions about which to meet
- promote the platform across the public sector

- coordinate product development with other products, disciplines and teams across the GDS and the government
- maintain knowledge of the changing digital and technology landscapes, and the opportunities they provide to improve the delivery of public services in the UK
- coach and mentor other product managers in your areas, identifying learning and development opportunities for individuals and teams
- support the Head of Product with development and implementation of wider product strategy

Person specification

The Lead Product Manager role will be assessed against our GDaD Capability Framework. In addition to below, please review the skills that will be assessed here.

We re interested in people who have experience of:

- product managing high-volume digital products in a fast-paced, agile environment, working with multidisciplinary teams from discovery through to delivery and continuous, data-led improvement of live services
- owning and evolving a product s roadmap and priorities, ensuring a balance between new delivery and reliable, effective live service operation
- developing and improving a product s operational maturity as well as ensuring a consistent approach to user and technical operational support
- leading and directing stakeholder engagement, using strong communication skills to align on needs, priorities and delivery decisions
- contributing to the development of product and commercial strategies, helping to secure funding and ongoing support
- working in or with public sector organisations, including cross-organisational working and navigating spend control processes and procurement
- recruiting, coaching and line management of product managers, identifying learning and development opportunities for individuals and teams

Benefits

There are many benefits of working at GDS, including:

- flexible hybrid working with flexi-time and the option to work part-time or condensed hours
- a Civil Service Pension with an average employer contribution of 28.97%
- 25 days of annual leave, increasing by a day each year up to a maximum of 30 days
- an extra day off for the King s birthday
- an in-year bonus scheme to recognise high performance
- career progression and coaching, including a training budget for personal development
- a focus on wellbeing with access to an employee assistance programme
- job satisfaction from making government services easier to use and more inclusive for people across the UK
- advances on pay, including for travel season tickets
- death in service benefits
- cycle to work scheme and facilities
- access to an employee discounts scheme
- 10 learning days per year
- volunteering opportunities (5 special leave days per year)
- access to a suite of learning activities through Civil Service learning

Any move to Government Digital Service from another employer will mean you can no longer access childcare vouchers. This includes moves between government departments. You may however be eligible for other government schemes, including Tax Free Childcare. Determine your eligibility at https://www.childcarechoices.gov.uk

Office attendance
The Department operates a discretionary hybrid working policy, which provides for a combination of working hours from your place of work and from

your home in the UK. The current expectation for staff is to attend the office or non-home based location for 40-60% of the time over the accounting period.
DSIT does not normally offer full home working (i.e. working at home); but we do offer a variety of flexible working options (including occasionally working from home).

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our candidate guidance (opens in a new window) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

The standard selection process for roles at GDS consists of:

- a simple application screening process - We only ask for a CV and cover letter of up to 500 words. Important tip - please ensure that your cover letter includes how you meet the skills and experience listed in the person specification section above
- A short phone interview
- A 75 minute interview based on the behaviour and competencies listed and your experience. The interview will include the following elements:
  - A presentation based on topic provided in advance
  - A series of interview questions

Depending on how many applications we get, there might also be an extra stage before the video interview, for example a phone interview or a technical exercise.

In the event we receive a high volume of applications, we will conduct the initial sift against the lead criteria which is:

product managing high-volume digital products in a fast-paced, agile environment, working with multidisciplinary teams from discovery through to delivery and continuous, data-led improvement of live services

In the Civil Service, we use Success Profiles to evaluate your skills and ability. This gives us the best possible chance of finding the right person for the job, increases performance and improves diversity and inclusivity. We ll be assessing your technical abilities, skills, experience and behaviours that are relevant to this role.

For this role we ll be assessing you against the following Civil Service Behaviours:

leadership

seeing the bigger picture

changing and improving

making effective decisions

delivering at pace

communicating and influencing

We ll also be assessing your experience and specialist technical skills against the following skills defined in the Government Digital and Data Capability Framework for the Lead Product Manager role:

Agile and lean practices

Applying user-centred insights

Creating value for money

Lifecycle management

Managing product outcomes

Product leadership

Product management

Stakeholder relationship management

Strategic ownership

Want to know more about who Government Digital and Data are? Click Here

Recruitment Timeline

Sift completion: 28th April 2026

Phone screening: From 6th May

Panel interviews: W/C 18th May

Candidates that do not pass the interview but have demonstrated an acceptable standard may be considered for similar roles at a lower grade.

A reserve list will be held for a period of 12 months, from which further appointments can be made.

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan and the Civil Service D&I Strategy.

Sponsorship

DSIT cannot offer Visa sponsorship to candidates through this campaign. DSIT holds a Visa sponsorship licence but this can only be used for certain roles and this campaign does not qualify.

Location

Whilst this role's location is Manchester/London, if you are a current Civil servant working in DSIT and based in Bristol, you are also able to apply for this role. If you are successful, you will retain your Bristol location and pay.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a criminal record check.

People working with government assets must complete baseline personnel security standard (opens in new window) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

- UK nationals
- nationals of the Republic of Ireland
- nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS) (opens in a new window)
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)
- individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020
- Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

Further information on nationality requirements (opens in a new window)

Working for the Civil Service

The Civil Service Code (opens in a new window) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's recruitment principles (opens in a new window).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan (opens in a new window) and the Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy (opens in a new window).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the Great Place to Work for Veterans (opens in a new window) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. Read more about prison leaver recruitment (opens in new window).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Email : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Further information

If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles and you wish to make a complaint, you should contact gds-complaints@dsit.gov.uk in the first instance.

If you are not satisfied with the response you receive you can contact the Civil Service Commission by email: info@csc.gov.uk Or in writing: Civil Service Commission, Room G/8 1 Horse Guards Road, London, SW1A 2HQ.

Civil Service Commission

disability confident EMPLOYER